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Rewiring Payments

The rail is becoming easier to rent, and the battle is moving above it. This week, Revolut added a euro stablecoin without becoming the issuer, Walmart conceded that even the largest merchant cannot dictate consumer payment behaviour, agentic commerce highlighted the growing importance of who controls the checkout, and Stripe walked away from PayPal. Different developments, same message: as infrastructure becomes more modular and accessible, value is moving toward distribution, merchant integration, identity, authorization, routing and reconciliation.

For Adyen, the direction is strategically supportive, although the benefit is not automatic. Easier access to infrastructure raises the importance of owning the merchant relationship and embedding more deeply into commerce. For Wise, the near-term earnings impact remains limited, but the mid-term read-across is modestly negative as scaled competitors gain more ways to narrow product gaps quickly.

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Revolut Rents the Rail, Narrowing the Gap

Revolut has begun rolling out EURR, its first euro-backed stablecoin, to selected customers in Denmark, Poland, and Portugal, with broader EEA availability expected later in 2026 subject to product, operational, and regulatory readiness. EURR is issued by Bridge Building, a Stripe-owned company, while Revolut distributes the token through its retail app. The token is initially available on Ethereum, with external wallet transfers available to selected customers and planned to broaden as liquidity develops.

Our take: For Wise, we see negligible near-term earnings risk but a modest negative medium-term read-across. EURR does not replicate Wise's broader cross-border offering, including local accounts, FX, liquidity, and payout. But Revolut can now add a regulated on-chain rail through a third-party provider, reducing the time and cost required to expand its cross-border infrastructure.

Walmart Follows the Consumer, Not the Other Way Around

Walmart has started a phased roll-out of contactless payments across U.S. Walmart and Sam's Club locations, including Apple Pay and Google Pay, with nationwide availability targeted by year-end. Contactless support is being added alongside existing options, including Walmart Pay, rather than replacing the retailer's proprietary payment method.

Our take: Walmart's history makes the decision more significant. Walmart spent years supporting proprietary and retailer-led alternatives designed to keep payments inside its own ecosystem and reduce dependence on traditional



payment economics. Those efforts did not remove the underlying constraint: consumers already had preferred payment credentials and interfaces. Even the largest merchant ultimately had to add the methods customers wanted to use.

For Adyen, payment-method proliferation expands the problem its platform is designed to solve: accepting consumers' preferred methods while optimizing conversion, authorization, routing, and economics through one merchant integration.

Agentic Commerce Starts with Controlled Authority

A recent NMI survey of 1,000 U.S. adults found that 11% had used AI to complete a transaction, while 70% wanted the ability to review or override an AI purchase decision and 69% did not trust AI to process payments securely. Only 10% said they would give AI full control over a purchase.

Our take: The data suggest that adoption is likely to develop in stages: assistance first, constrained execution second, and broad autonomy later. Consumers may allow AI to search, compare, and recommend well before they grant an agent unrestricted authority to spend.

That makes controlled delegation the first meaningful infrastructure opportunity, rather than autonomous transaction volume. Platforms need to establish who authorized the agent, what the agent is permitted to buy, how much it may spend, which credential it may use, and who carries liability if the transaction is disputed or fraudulent. Identity, permissioning, authentication, fraud controls, credential security, and dispute allocation are therefore central to adoption.

For Adyen, this supports the logic behind Adyen Agentic Commerce, but execution remains key. The opportunity is to become the payments control layer for agentic commerce, validating authorization, applying the right credentials and risk controls, and executing transactions securely across merchants and payment methods.

Stripe and Advent Walk Away from PayPal

Stripe and Advent have reportedly ended their pursuit of PayPal after a bid of more than \$53 billion was rejected.

Our take: For Adyen, the relevant point is that a potentially more disruptive competitive outcome has been removed. A Stripe acquisition of PayPal would have raised a real question around Braintree, as combining two major enterprise payments competitors could have altered pricing, distribution, and competitive intensity. With the deal off the table, that specific risk has receded and the competitive structure remains unchanged.



Appendix 1

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